

The River Answers Back: The Disagreement

河流的回应：分歧

Theme: 环境、自然与可持续发展 · New: 44 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 44/6, 127

English Story

The disagreement was about the **ground** itself, and it began **with a tree**. “You **plant a dam** and the **sea** takes the delta,” the ecologist said. “You leave the mud alone and the **animal** comes back. Both **of us** are **against the fog of a single answer**.”

The **cultural** argument was harder: a **branch of** the ministry wanted a **rock zone** for the **media**, a **planet-friendly** slogan, and a **mobile** exhibition. “A **bow** and a **fossil** are worth more to a museum than to a river,” the director said. “We can be even more careful and still be late.”

The scheme on the table had nothing to do **with milk, pepper, or juice**: it was about who owned the **horizon**. “If we wait for a scheme that protects the whole **ecological axis**, we will wait for ten years,” Lin said. “If we pull the scheme apart, we lose the peat and the **shell** beds.”

The **exploitation of** the **zone** was already visible: a **jet of** warm water, a **cube of** concrete, a **plague of** algae, and a **plough** that turned the **dew** into dust. “The **ecology of** this **zone** is not a **cultural** ornament,” the ecologist said.

The compromise they could live **with** was smaller than either side wanted. A **leather** boot, a **wool** blanket, a **comb**, and a packet **of bacon** were the whole **of** the field kit; from that list they reproduced a plan **with** a single **branch**.

The end of the argument was that nothing was settled and everything was clearer. “We are able to measure a **pollutant** and not able to agree on a **horizon**,” the director said. “The next story will have to begin **with** that.” The **mate of** the ecologist brought **bedding**, **corn**, and a bag **of peanut**; the **smog** over the bank was the only thing at the low level of the river that the body could feel. The movement of the water and the result of the survey were on the same page for once. This **planet** has one river and one plan, and the plan must include both, unbuilt pier or not.

中文翻译

分歧就出在地本身，而且是从一棵树开始的。“你筑一道坝，海就会夺走三角洲，”生态学家说，“你让泥滩保持原样，动物就会回来。我们两人都反对单一答案的那层迷雾。”

文化层面的论证更难：部里的一个分支想要一片给媒体的岩石区、一句对地球友好的口号，以及一个移动展览。“一把弓和一块化石对博物馆的价值大于对一条河的价值，”主管说，“即便我们再小心，也依然是迟的。”

桌上的方案与奶、胡椒或果汁都无关：它关乎谁来拥有那条地平线。“如果我们等一个保护整个生态轴的方案，我们要等十年，”林伟说，“如果我们把方案拆开，我们就失去泥炭和贝壳层。”

对这一地带的开发已经看得见了：一股温水射流、一块混凝土立方体、一场藻类瘟疫，以及一张把露水翻成尘土的犁。“这一地带的生态不是一件文化装饰品，”生态学家说。

他们能接受的妥协比双方想要的都小。一只皮靴、一条羊毛毯、一把梳子，以及一包熏猪肉就是野外装备的全部；他们从这份清单里复现出一个单分支的方案。

这场争论的结局是：什么都没解决，而一切都更清楚了。“我们有能力测量一种污染物，却没有能力就一条地平线达成一致，”主管说，“下一个故事必须从这里开始。”那位生态学家的伙伴带来了被褥、玉米和一袋花生；岸边那层烟雾，是身体在河流低水位处唯一能感觉到的东西。水的运动和调查的结果，这一次在同一页上。这颗行星只有一条河和一个方案，而方案必须同时包含两者，无论那座码头建不建。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
of ɒv POS: prep	prep. 的, 属于 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: prep. In a general sense, from, or out from; proceeding from;; belonging to; relating to; concerning; -- us...
with wɪð POS: prep	prep. 和...在一起, 以, 由于 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. See Withe.; prep. With denotes or expresses some situation or relation of; nearness, proximity, associati...
against ə'geɪnst POS: prep	prep. 反对, 对着, 倚靠 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: prep. Abreast; opposite to; facing; towards; as, against the; mouth of a river; -- in this sense often prec...
ground graʊnd POS: n	n. 土地, 战场, 场地, 地面, 范围; a. 土地的, 地面上的; vt. 放在地上, 使搁浅, 打基础, 给...以训练; vi. 搁浅... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a position to be won or defended in battle (or as if in battle); n. a relatively homogeneous percept extend...
tree tri: POS: n	n. 树, 木料, 树状物; vt. 把...赶上树; [计] 树; DOS外部命令:显示指定磁盘驱动器的目录结构 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a tall perennial woody plant having a main trunk and branches forming a distinct elevated crown; includes...
plant plænt, plɑ:nt POS: n	n. 植物, 作物, 工厂, 树枝, 生长, 设施, 成套设备; vt. 种植, 栽培, 播种, 培养, 安置, 殖民于, 使位于; vi. ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. buildings for carrying on industrial labor; n. (botany) a living organism lacking the power of locomotion; n...
animal 'æniməl POS: n	n. 动物; [医] 动物 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a living organism characterized by voluntary movement; s. marked by the appetites and passions of the body
sea si: POS: n	n. 海, 海洋, 海浪, 大量; [法] 海, 海洋 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a division of an ocean or a large body of salt water partially enclosed by land; n. turbulent water with sw...
media 'mi:diə POS: n	n. 媒体; [计] 媒质 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a means or instrumentality for storing or communicating information; n the surrounding environment; n an inte...
rock rɒk POS: n	n. 岩石, 岩礁, 石头, 基石, 暗礁, 摇动, 摇滚乐; vt. 摇摆, 摇动, 使摇晃, 使动摇; vi. 摇, 摇动 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a lump or mass of hard consolidated mineral matter; n. material consisting of the aggregate of minerals lik...
cultural 'kʌltʃərəl POS: a	a. 文化的, 教养的, 修养的; [医] 培养的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or relating to the arts and manners that a group favors; s. denoting or deriving from or distinctive of...
branch bræntʃ POS: n	n. 树枝, 支店, 支流, 分部; vi. 分支, 出枝; vt. 分割, 用枝状叶脉刺绣花纹装饰; [计] 分支, 目录分支 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a division of some larger or more complex organization; n. a division of a stem, or secondary stem arising...
planet 'plænit POS: n	n. 行星, 命运星辰, 杰出的人, 重大影响的事 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (astronomy) any of the nine large celestial bodies in the solar system that revolve around the sun and shi...
zone zəʊn POS: n	n. 地带, 带, 地区; vt. 环绕, 使分成地带; vi. 分成区; [计] 卡片顶部的三行区; 区; 区域 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a locally circumscribed place characterized by some distinctive features; n. any of the regions of the surf...
milk mɪlk POS: n	n. 奶, 乳状物; vt. 挤乳, 榨取; vi. 产乳 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a white nutritious liquid secreted by mammals and used as food by human beings; n. produced by mammary glan...
pepper 'pepə POS: n	n. 胡椒粉, 胡椒, 辣椒; [化] 胡椒; 辣椒; 花椒 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. climber having dark red berries (peppercorns) when fully ripe; southern India and Sri Lanka; naturalized i...
juice dʒu:s POS: n	n. 汁, 活力, 体液; vt. 挤出汁来, 加汁 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the liquid part that can be extracted from plant or animal tissue by squeezing or cooking; n. energetic vit...
corn kɔ:n POS: n	n. 玉蜀黍, 谷类, 谷粒, 鸡眼; vt. 使成颗粒, 腌 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. tall annual cereal grass bearing kernels on large ears: widely cultivated in America in many varieties; th...
shell fel POS: n	n. 贝壳, 壳, 外形, 炮弹; vt. 去壳, 脱落, 炮轰; vi. 剥落, 脱壳; [计] 外壳; DOS内部命令:指定命令行处理程序 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. ammunition consisting of a cylindrical metal casing containing an explosive charge and a projectile; fired...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
leather 'leðə POS: n	n. 皮革, 皮制品, 马镫的皮带; vt. 覆以皮革, 鞭苔, 抽打; a. 皮革的, 皮制的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an animal skin made smooth and flexible by removing the hair and then tanning; v. whip with a leather strap
mate meɪt POS: n	n. 配偶, 对手, 助手, (象棋)将死; vt. 使配对, 使一致, 结伴, (象棋)将死; vi. 成配偶, 紧密配合 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the officer below the master on a commercial ship; n. the partner of an animal (especially a sexual partner)...
horizon he'raɪzən POS: n	n. 地平线, 眼界, (天)视地平 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the line at which the sky and Earth appear to meet; n. the range of interest or activity that can be anticipated...
jet dʒet POS: n	n. 喷射流, 喷嘴, 煤玉; v. 射出, 进出, 喷射; a. 黑而发亮的, 墨黑的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an airplane powered by one or more jet engines; n. the occurrence of a sudden discharge (as of liquid); n. a...
wool wʊl POS: n	n. 羊毛, 毛织物, 毛线, 绒线; [医] 羊毛, 绒毛, 棉[花] Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a fabric made from the hair of sheep; n. fiber sheared from animals (such as sheep) and twisted into yarn...
bow bəu.bau POS: n	n. 弓, 眼睛框; v. 用弓拉琴, 弯成弓形; n. 鞠躬, 屈服 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a knot with two loops and loose ends; used to tie shoelaces; n. a slightly curved piece of resilient wood...
reproduce .ri:prə'dju:s POS: v	v. 繁殖, 再生, 复制, 生殖; [计] 复制 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make a copy or equivalent of; v. have offspring or produce more individuals of a given animal or plant; v. r...
ecological .i:kə'lɒdʒɪkəl POS: a	a. 生态学的, 主张生态保护的; [法] 生态的, 生态学的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. characterized by the interdependence of living organisms in an environment; a. of or relating to the science...
dam dæm POS: n	n. 水坝, 障碍; v. 控制, 筑坝; [计] 直接存取法 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a barrier constructed to contain the flow of water or to keep out the sea; n. female parent of an animal...
mobile 'məʊbɪl POS: a	a. 移动的, 易变的, 机动的; n. 活动物体 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a river in southwestern Alabama; flows into Mobile Bay; n. a port in southwestern Alabama on Mobile Bay; n. ...
peanut 'pi:nʌt POS: n	n. 花生, 小人物, 极小的数额; a. 渺小的, 微不足道的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. underground pod of the peanut vine; n. widely cultivated American plant cultivated in tropical and warm regions...
fossil 'fɒsəl POS: n	n. 化石, 古物; a. 化石的, 陈腐的, 守旧的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the remains (or an impression) of a plant or animal that existed in a past geological age and that has been...
exploitation .eksplɔɪ'teɪʃən POS: n	n. 开发, 开采, 剥削; [经] 开发, 剥削, 宣传 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of making some area of land or water more profitable or productive or useful; n. an act that exploits...
fog fɒg POS: n	n. 雾, 迷惑, (割后的)最生草, 苔藓; vi. 被雾笼罩, 变模糊; vt. 使困惑, 以雾笼罩 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. droplets of water vapor suspended in the air near the ground; n. an atmosphere in which visibility is reduced...
axis 'æksɪs POS: n	n. 轴; [计] 坐标轴 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a straight line through a body or figure that satisfies certain conditions; n. the main stem or central part...
cube kju:b POS: n	n. 立方体, 立方; [机] 立方体, 立方 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a hexahedron with six equal squares as faces; n. the product of three equal terms; n. any of several tropical...
bacon 'beɪkən POS: n	n. 熏猪肉; [机] 腌肉 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. back and sides of a hog salted and dried or smoked; usually sliced thin and fried; n. English scientist and...
ecology .i:'kɒlədʒi POS: n	n. 生态学, 社会生态学; [化] 生态学 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the environment as it relates to living organisms; n. the branch of biology concerned with the relationships between...
plague pleɪg POS: n	n. 瘟疫, 天罚, 麻烦, 灾祸; vt. 折磨, 使苦恼, 使得灾祸 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a serious (sometimes fatal) infection of rodents caused by Yersinia pestis and accidentally transmitted to...
plough plau POS: n	n. 犁, 犁过地; vi. 用犁耕田, 开路; vt. 耕, 犁, 开路 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a group of seven bright stars in the constellation Ursa Major; n a farm tool having one or more heavy blades...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
comb kəʊm POS: n	n. 头梳, 鸡冠; vt. 梳头发, 梳毛; vi. (浪)涌起 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a flat device with narrow pointed teeth on one edge; disentangles or arranges hair; n. the fleshy red crest...
pollutant pe'lu:tənt POS: n	n. 污染物质; [法] 污染物 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. waste matter that contaminates the water or air or soil
bedding 'bedɪŋ POS: n	n. 被褥, 寝具, 床上用品, 基床; [机] 褥草, 被褥 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n coverings that are used on a bed; n material used to provide a bed for animals; v furnish with a bed; v place...
smog sməʊg POS: n	n. 烟雾; [化] 烟雾 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. air pollution by a mixture of smoke and fog
dew dju: POS: n	n. 露珠, 露水; vt. (用露水)沾湿; vi. 结露水 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. water that has condensed on a cool surface overnight from water vapor in the air